

YOUR FULL REPORT

Are you being a bad friend?

Some friendship drift

Score band: 14–26 points · Relationships

What this report covers

A reset for the small inconsistencies that can leave friends unsure where they stand.

Inside:

1. Where effort may be drifting
2. Repairing missed replies and canceled plans
3. How to communicate your capacity honestly

→ Full details for each section on page 2

Your result

Some friendship drift (14–26 points)

A few habits may leave friends unsure where they stand. You might be stretched thin, avoidant, or unaware of an imbalance.

Try this next

Choose one overdue follow-through—reply, reschedule, check in—and do it without excuses.

Your practical guide

A reset for the small inconsistencies that can leave friends unsure where they stand.

1 Where effort may be drifting

Drift rarely announces itself; it accumulates in small unreturned volleys. Audit honestly: whose message has been sitting for days because replying felt like too much? Which plan did you cancel with a vague excuse and never reschedule? Where have you been taking more than you give — venting without asking, accepting help without offering it? Pick the single clearest instance, not all of them. Drift feels overwhelming in aggregate but is usually repaired one gesture at a time. The friendship is probably not broken; it is just waiting for someone to go first, and that someone can be you.

2 Repairing missed replies and canceled plans

Repair is simpler than you fear. For the missed reply: "I am sorry I went dark — your message deserved better than silence. How did the interview go?" For the canceled plan: "I canceled and never followed up, and that was not fair. Are you free next Saturday?" Notice the pattern: brief ownership, no dramatic excuses, a concrete new offer. Do not over-apologize — one sincere acknowledgment beats five anxious ones, which make the other person comfort you instead. If they are cool at first, give it time; trust rebuilds on the second and third consistent gesture, not the first grand one.

3 How to communicate your capacity honestly

The kindest thing you can say to a friend is the true size of your capacity. "I want to be there for you, and honestly I only have about twenty minutes tonight" respects you both — it prevents the resentful yes and the guilty no. Distinguish seasons from patterns: a hard month is a season, and naming it ("work is brutal until June") buys patience; chronic unavailability is a pattern, and it deserves an honest conversation about what the friendship can realistically be. Most friends would rather have a clear, smaller place in your life than a large, unreliable one. Say the true thing once, and watch how much pressure leaves the friendship.